

گر منی گنده بود همچون منی چون به جان پیوست یابد روشنی	125 If egoism is foul-smelling like semen, when it attains unto the spirit it gains light.
هر جمادی که کند رو در نبات از درخت بخت او روید حیات	Every mineral that sets its face towards the plant—life grows from the tree of its fortune.
هر نباتی کان به جان رو آورد خضروار از چشمه‌ی حیوان خورد	Every plant that turns its face towards the spirit drinks, like Khizr, from the Fountain of Life.
باز جان چون رو سوی جانان نهد رخت را در عمر بی‌پایان نهد	Once more, when the spirit sets its face towards the Beloved, it lays down its baggage into the life without end.

سؤال سائل از مرغی که بر سر ربض شهری نشسته باشد سر او فاضلتر است و عزیزتر و شریفتر
و مکرمت‌تر یا دم او و جواب دادن واعظ سائل را به قدر فهم او

*How an inquirer asked about a bird that was supposed to have settled on the wall of a city—
“Is its head more excellent and estimable and noble and honourable or its tail?”—
and how the preacher gave him a reply suited to the measure of his understanding.*

واعظی را گفت روزی سائلی کای تو منبر را سنی‌تر قایل	One day an inquirer said to a preacher, “O you who are the pulpit’s most eminent expounder,
يك سؤال استم یگو ای ذو لباب اندر این مجلس سؤالم را جواب	130 I have a question to ask. Answer my question in this assembly-place, O possessor of the marrow.
بر سر بارو یکی مرغی نشست از سر و از دم کدامینش به است	A bird has settled on the city-wall: which is better—its head or its tail?”
گفت اگر رویش به شهر و دم به ده روی او از دم او می‌دان که به	He replied, “If its face is to the town and its tail to the country, know that its face is better than its tail;
ور سوی شهر است دم رویش بده خاك آن دم باش و از رویش بجه	But if its tail is towards the town and its face to the country, be the dust on that tail and spring away from its face.”
مرغ با پر می‌پرد تا آشیان پر مردم همت است ای مردمان	A bird flies to its nest by means of wings: the wings of Man are aspiration, O people.
عاشقی کالوده شد در خیر و شر خیر و شر منگر تو در همت نگر	135 The lover who is soiled with good and evil, do not regard the good and evil; regard the aspiration.
باز اگر باشد سپید و بی‌نظیر چون که صیدش موش باشد شد حقیر	If a falcon be white and beyond compare, it becomes despicable when it hunts a mouse;
ور بود جغدی و میل او به شاه او سر باز است منگر در کلاه	And if there be an owl that has desire for the king, it is the falcon’s head: do not regard the hood.
آدمی بر قد يك طشت خمیر بر فزود از آسمان و از اثیر	Man, no bigger than a kneading-trough, has surpassed the heavens and the ether.